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Speech Scripts

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Birthday Candles

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Birthday Candles

By K.R. Schneider

(Twin girls, Sam and Sawyer, sit back to back.)

Sawyer: Twenty three candles this year.

Sam: Twenty-three is a lot.

Sawyer: You thought nineteen was a lot.

Sam: So imagine how I'm feeling now!

Sawyer: Old?

Sam: Practically ancient!

Sawyer: You know, Mom and Dad are like twice that.

Sam: Yeah, Sawyer, and they're old!

Sawyer: I think, Samantha, they'd be offended by that.

Sam: Oh, old people get offended by everything.

(Laughter; brief silence. Sawyer is plucking at a bouquet of flowers in her lap.)

Sawyer: Hey, thanks for the flowers.

Sam: Well it is our birthday.

Sawyer: Not yet it isn't. What time is it?

Sam: (*checks watch)* 11:18

Sawyer: *(exasperated)* Like forty more minutes!

Sam: She says like it's such a chore to hang out with me.

Sawyer: You are kind of a headache.

Sam: Oh whatever; I'm a joy to be around.

Sawyer: You know, I thought the **younger** child was supposed to be the entitled one.

Sam: *(surprised)* You're not younger. We're the same age.

Sawyer: Nope. **Technically** I am younger.

Sam: And you say I'm a headache.

Sawyer: You are!

Sam: Oh like when?

Sawyer: Does our 8th birthday ring a bell?

(Flashback to 8th birthday; Sawyer stands on chair, holding a hamster in the air above her head.)

Sam: SAWYER, PUT PEBBLES BACK IN HER CAGE!

Sawyer: TELL MOM THAT YOU WANT TO HAVE CHOCOLATE CAKE WITH *PINK* FROSTING!

Sam: No! It's MY turn and I want *white* cake with *green* frosting!
Sawyer: Pink and chocolate, Sammy, or the rat GETS IT!
Sam: Mom! Sawyer is gonna kill Pebbles!
Sawyer: You are SUCH a BABY!
Sam: If you kill Pebbles, I'll kill YOU!
Sawyer: MOOMMM! Sammy is gonna kill me!
Sam: Gimme Pebbles!
Sawyer: I'm gonna bake her in the stupid cake!
Sam: Mom!
Sawyer: Mom!
Sam and **Sawyer**: MOM!

(Back to the present; both girls are laughing.)

Sawyer: You were being a serious baby.
Sam: It was MY turn!
Sawyer: You got your white cake didn't you?
Sam: Yeah, but it had **pink** frosting!
Sawyer: (*laughs)* Yeah, well...Mom always was the master of a compromise.
Sam: She was a pro at that whole: "it's the same; it's just different" crap.

(Flashback; 13 years old; in the backseat of the car)

Sam: I didn't want the same pencil bag as Sawyer!
Mom: They're not the same, Samantha. Yours is blue.
Sawyer: How come Sam gets to have a cooler backpack than me!?
Mom: They're the same, Sawyer; yours is just green.

(Back to the present)

Sawyer: Quite a woman: our mother.
Sam: Definitely sainthood material.
(Brief silence; the tone seems to shift; Sam tries to lighten it again).
Sam: Favorite birthday - go.
Sawyer: Hmm. Six was definitely up there: the face paint, the bouncy castle.
Sam: Six was terrible! I broke my arm in that stupid castle!
Sawyer: (*laughs)* That's right; you cried all your face paint off.

Sam: I went to the hospital looking like a pink and purple snot ball.
Sawyer: Yeah; you were an awfully sad butterfly.

(Flashback ; six years old; in the car on the way to the hospital; Sam has a broken arm.)

Sam: It hurts, it hurts, it hurts, it hurts!
Sawyer: (*rubbing her own arm)* Don't cry, Sammy! Your pretty butterfly will smudge!
Sam: I hate stupid bouncy castles!
Sawyer: *(determined)* Me too!
Sam: I hate stupid face paint!
Sawyer: *(slightly less determined)* Me too!
Sam: I hate my stupid birthday!
Sawyer: (*brief pause)* Me too.
(Sam notices that Sawyer is holding her own arm and touches it softly).
Sam: What's wrong with *your* arm?
Sawyer: *(concerned)* Sammy, are you gonna get a cast?
Sam: *(upset)* If they make me!
Sawyer: I'll get one too. Then we'll be the same still.
Sam: *(lays her head on Sawyer's shoulder)* We're the same all the time.

(Back to present)

Sawyer: They wouldn't give me that cast no matter how much I begged.
Sam: When they told you no, I think you cried more than I did!
Sawyer: I wanted us to be the same.
Sam: We're always the same.
Sawyer: Sometimes that's not the best thing.

(Flashback; fifteen years old; Homecoming; both girls are wearing the same dress).

Sawyer: You can't wear that!
Sam: I picked it first!
Sawyer: Did not!
Sam: Did too!
Sawyer: I told you we should have gone shopping together!
Sam: I wanted to pick my own dress!
Sawyer: Well you didn't pick your own dress, Samantha, you picked MY dress!

Sam: Shut up, Sawyer! Maybe YOU picked MY dress!
Sawyer: Did not!
Sam: Did too!
Sawyer: Shut up! Change!
Sam: You change!
Sam and **Sawyer**: MOM!

(Back to present).

Sawyer: Lesson learned.
Sam: Don't shop separately.
Sawyer: You know, that homecoming dance was actually fun.
Sam: Ohhh right! You kissed Tommy Higgins.
Sawyer: My first kiss.
Sam: *The* first kiss.
Sawyer: It's probably the only thing I ever did before you.

(Flashback; after the dance; fifteen years old; Sam on the top bunk; Sawyer on the bottom).

Sam: Where?
Sawyer: Uh...my mouth.
Sam: No, dummy. *Where*. Like on the dance floor?
Sawyer: In the hallway by the first floor trophy case.
Sam: That's a good hallway!
Sawyer: Why is that a good hallway!?
Sam: Well, you got kissed there right? So it MUST be a good hallway!
Sawyer: *(laughs)* I guess.
Sam: So!?
Sawyer: So what?
Sam: So you got kissed, Sawyer! What was it like!?
Sawyer: Uhm...warm?
Sam: Gross. Warm? That's the best you can come up with?
Sawyer: Well, I don't know, Sam! It's not like I was taking notes! It was a kiss.
Sam: Oh sure, like we *all* know what a kiss feels like!
Sawyer: *(sighs)* It was...kind of awkward, and I laughed, and he seemed kind of shy…
Sam: So it was incredible?
Sawyer: Yeah...it was incredible.

(Back to present).

Sam: I heard he got married last year.
Sawyer: Married? Woah. Tommy Higgins is somebody's husband.
Sam: Jealous?
Sawyer: Nah. The first kiss was okay and all, but...
Sam: Not a tough loss?
Sawyer: Definitely not the great love of my life.
Sam: Yeah.
Sawyer: Hey Sammy?
Sam: Huh?
Sawyer: What ever happened to Paris? This was supposed to be the year for Europe, right? You were gonna' turn 23 under the Eiffel Tower and all that?
Sam: Paris is still there.
Sawyer: And you aren't with it because?
Sam: Because I'm with you. It's our birthday, dummy.
Sawyer: It's **your** birthday.
Sam: No. It's not. It's ours.
Sawyer: I don't think birthdays count anymore when you die. I don't get older.
Sam: It's still your birthday, Sawyer. You were born on this day. With me. You and me. Together. It's still *our* birthday.
Sawyer: Hey, I'm supposed to be the know-it-all in this relationship.
Sam: Not about this. You died. You relinquish your right to know best.
Sawyer: Sammy…
Sam: It's our birthday, Sawyer. It is.
Sawyer: Okay. It's our birthday. So...since it's *our* birthday, can I put in a request?
Sam: What?
Sawyer: Go to Europe. Next year, turn twenty-four under the Eiffel Tower. Eat gelato, and fall in love with some guy with an accent. Wear a beret.
Sam: A beret?
Sawyer: Whatever. Do anything, okay? Just don't spend your--*our* birthday talking to a headstone. Don't bring me flowers, or eat cake in the cemetery like a weirdo. Have adventures. Live a life.
Sam: I don't want to go to Europe without you. I don't want to see great places or eat gelato by myself, Sawyer. I want to do it with you. And you're not here. You left. You bailed on me, and now it's like I'm only half a person!

Sawyer: You're a whole person, Sammy. And I didn't bail! I wanted to stay. I wanted to grow up and fall in love and eat birthday cake with you every year until we were 100! But it didn't work that way!
Sam: Why not!? It's not fair! You went to that stupid party and you got in that stupid car like a stupid idiot! You left me here, Sawyer, and it's not fair!
Sawyer: I know. I'm sorry.
Sam: Do you know that by the time that they told me, I already knew? I could feel it: like all of a sudden I didn't have enough limbs.
Sawyer: It's that whole twin thing.
Sam: And now I'm twenty-three, and I didn't go to Paris, and I buy two of everything, and I hate my birthday! And you're still...nineteen.
Sawyer: I'm sorry, Sammy. *(Sawyer lays her head back against Sam's. They link fingers).* I wish...I wish a lot of things.
Sam: I love you, Sawyer.
Sam: I love you, Sam. *(Brief silence. Sawyer taps Sam's watch)* Look. You're twenty-three.
Sam: *(checks watch) I'm* twenty-three.
Sawyer: Samantha. I'd never really bail on you, you know? I'll be around.
Sam: I never *could* go anywhere without you.
Sawyer: Like you'd want to.
Sam: No; I wouldn't want to.
Sawyer: Next birthday...take me to Europe?
Sam: I'll put your flowers under the Eiffel Tower.
Sawyer: That's way cooler than a headstone. And you'll eat cake underneath it?
Sam: Absolutely. Chocolate with pink frosting.
Sawyer: Twenty-four candles next year.
Sam: Twenty-four is a lot.